Admissions Officer Dashboard - Complete User Manual

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Overview

The Admissions Officer Dashboard is a comprehensive system designed to manage the entire student admissions lifecycle, from initial application submission through enrollment. This manual provides step-by-step instructions for all features and workflows available to admissions officers.

Key Features

- **Complete Application Management**: Create, view, edit, approve, and reject applications
- **Interview Scheduling**: Schedule and manage student interviews
- **Document Management**: Upload, review, and verify application documents
- **Communication Tools**: Send emails, notifications, and bulk messages
- **Analytics & Reporting**: Generate comprehensive reports and track metrics
- **Import/Export**: Bulk import applications and export data
- **Multi-tenant Support**: Secure, school-specific data isolation

Access Requirements

- **Role**: `admissions-officer`, `school-admin`, or `slate-admin`
- **Authentication**: Valid login credentials for your school
- **URL Format**: `/{school_code}/dashboard/admissions-officer`

Getting Started

Logging In

1. Navigate to your school's login page: `/{school_code}/login`
2. Enter your email and password
3. Click "Sign In"
4. You will be redirected to the Admissions Officer Dashboard

Dashboard Navigation

The dashboard features a collapsible sidebar with the following main sections:

- **Dashboard**: Overview, Analytics, Activities
- **Applications**: All Applications, New Application
- **Interview Management**: Interview Calendar, Schedule Interview, Interview Reports
- **Document Management**: All Documents, Document Templates
- **Reports & Analytics**: Admissions Reports, Transcripts, Enrollment Trends, Performance Metrics, Export Data
- **Communication**: Communication Center, Notifications, Email Templates, Bulk Communications
- **HRMS & Payroll**: Leave Management, Payroll Overview, Payslips, Payroll Reports, Training & Development
- **Settings & Tools**: Admissions Settings, Profile, Help & Support

Quick Actions

From the main dashboard, you can quickly access:

- **New Application**: Create a new student application
- **Import Data**: Bulk import applications from CSV
- **Export Data**: Export application data
- **Schedule Interview**: Quickly schedule an interview
- **Review Documents**: Access pending document reviews

Dashboard Overview

Main Dashboard Tabs

The dashboard is organized into 10 main tabs:

1. **Overview**: Dashboard summary with stats and recent activities
2. **Applications**: Complete application management
3. **Interviews**: Interview scheduling and management
4. **Documents**: Document upload and verification
5. **Reports**: Analytics and reporting tools
6. **Messaging**: Communication center
7. **Payroll**: Payroll and HRMS integration
8. **Trainings**: Training and development programs
9. **Counselor**: Counselor collaboration tools
10. **Settings**: System and personal settings

Statistics Cards

The dashboard displays key metrics:

- **Total Applications**: Count of all applications
- **Pending Review**: Applications awaiting review
- **Approved**: Successfully approved applications
- **Enrollment Rate**: Percentage of approved applications that enrolled

Recent Activity Feed

The Recent Activity section shows:

- Latest application submissions
- Status changes
- Interview schedules
- Document uploads
- System notifications

Applications Management

Viewing Applications

Accessing the Applications List

1. Navigate to **Applications** tab or click **"All Applications"** in the sidebar
2. The applications list displays all applications with:
    - Application Number
    - Student Name
    - Grade Applied For
    - Status
    - Application Date
    - Contact Information

Filtering Applications

By Status:

- All
- Pending
- Approved
- Rejected
- Interview Scheduled
- Documents Required

By Grade:

- Select from dropdown to filter by grade level

By Search:

- Use the search bar to find applications by:
    - Student name
    - Application number
    - Email address
    - Phone number

Sorting Applications

Click column headers to sort by:

- Application Date (default: newest first)

- Student Name (alphabetical)
- Status
- Grade

Creating a New Application

Method 1: From Dashboard

1. Click **"New Application"** button in Quick Actions
2. Or navigate to **Applications** → **New Application**

Method 2: From Applications List

1. Go to **Applications** tab
2. Click **"New Application"** button at the top

Application Form Sections

The application form includes multiple tabs:

1. Application Information

- Academic Year
- Grade Applied For (required)
- Application Type (New, Transfer, Returning)
- Previous School (if applicable)
- Previous Grade (if applicable)
- Reason for Transfer (if applicable)

2. Student Information

- First Name (required)
- Middle Name (optional)
- Last Name (required)
- Date of Birth (required)
- Gender (required)
- Nationality (required)
- Passport Number (optional)

3. Address Information

- Address Line 1 (required)
- Address Line 2 (optional)
- City (required)

- State (required)
- Postal Code (required)
- Country (required)
- Phone Number (required)
- Email Address (required)

4. Parent/Guardian Information

- Parent First Name (required)
- Parent Last Name (required)
- Parent Phone (required)
- Parent Email (required)
- Parent Occupation (optional)
- Parent Employer (optional)
- Emergency Contact Name (optional)
- Emergency Contact Phone (optional)
- Emergency Contact Relation (optional)

5. Academic Information

- Previous School Name
- Previous School Address
- Previous School Phone
- Previous School Email
- Previous Principal Name
- Academic Achievements
- Academic Challenges
- Learning Support Needed
- Learning Support Details

6. Medical Information

- Medical Conditions
- Allergies
- Medications
- Dietary Restrictions
- Emergency Medical Information

7. Additional Information

- Family Members at School
- Siblings Information
- Transportation Needed

- Transportation Details
- After School Activities
- Special Interests

8. Documents

- Upload required documents based on grade level and application type
- Document types include:
    - Birth Certificate
    - Previous School Records
    - Medical Records
    - Recommendation Letters
    - Passport/ID
    - Other supporting documents

9. Review

- Review all entered information
- Verify document uploads
- Submit application

Saving and Submitting

- **Save Draft**: Click "Save Draft" to save progress without submitting
- **Submit**: Click "Submit" to finalize and submit the application
- **Validation**: All required fields must be completed before submission

Viewing Application Details

1. From the applications list, click the **eye icon** or application number
2. The application details page shows:
    - Complete application information
    - Uploaded documents
    - Interview history
    - Status history
    - Workflow log
    - Action buttons (Edit, Approve, Reject, Schedule Interview)

Editing an Application

1. Navigate to application details
2. Click **"Edit"** button
3. Make necessary changes
4. Click **"Save Changes"**

5. Or navigate to **Applications** → **[Application ID]** → **Edit**

Note: Some fields may be locked after certain status changes.

Approving an Application

1. Open the application details page
2. Review all information and documents
3. Click **"Approve"** button
4. Confirm the approval
5. Optionally add approval notes
6. The application status changes to "Approved"
7. An approval email is automatically sent to the applicant

Rejecting an Application

1. Open the application details page
2. Click **"Reject"** button
3. Enter rejection reason (required)
4. Confirm the rejection
5. The application status changes to "Rejected"
6. A rejection email is automatically sent to the applicant

Deleting an Application

1. From the applications list, click the **three dots menu** (⋮)
2. Select **"Delete"**
3. Confirm deletion
4. **Warning**: This action cannot be undone

Application Status Workflow

Submitted → Pending Review → [Interview Scheduled] → Documents Verified → Approved/Rejected

Status Definitions:

- **Submitted**: Application has been submitted by applicant
- **Pending Review**: Awaiting admissions officer review
- **Interview Scheduled**: Interview has been scheduled
- **Documents Required**: Missing or incomplete documents
- **Documents Verified**: All documents have been verified
- **Approved**: Application has been approved
- **Rejected**: Application has been rejected

Interview Management

Viewing Interview Calendar

1. Navigate to **Interviews** tab or click **"Interview Calendar"** in sidebar
2. The calendar displays:
    - All scheduled interviews
    - Interview status
    - Interviewer information
    - Interview outcomes

Scheduling an Interview

Method 1: From Application Details

1. Open an application
2. Click **"Schedule Interview"** button
3. Fill in interview details:
    - Date (required)
    - Time (required)
    - Interview Type (In-person, Virtual, Phone)
    - Interviewer (required)
    - Location/Virtual Link
    - Notes
4. Click **"Schedule Interview"**
5. Confirmation email is sent to applicant

Method 2: From Interview Management

1. Navigate to **Interviews** → **Schedule Interview**
2. Select application from dropdown
3. Fill in interview details
4. Click **"Schedule Interview"**

Managing Interviews

Viewing Interview Details

1. Click on an interview in the calendar
2. View:
    - Application information

    - Interview details
    - Interviewer notes
    - Interview outcome

Updating Interview Status

1. Open interview details
2. Update status:
    - Scheduled
    - Completed
    - Cancelled
    - Rescheduled
3. Add interview notes
4. Record interview outcome (if completed)

Rescheduling an Interview

1. Open interview details
2. Click **"Reschedule"**
3. Select new date and time
4. Add rescheduling reason
5. Click **"Reschedule"**
6. Notification sent to applicant

Interview Reports

1. Navigate to **Interviews** → **Interview Reports**
2. View reports:
    - Interview statistics
    - Interview outcomes
    - Interviewer performance
    - Interview trends
3. Export reports as needed

Document Management

Viewing Documents

1. Navigate to **Documents** tab or click **"All Documents"** in sidebar
2. View all documents organized by:
    - Application
    - Document type

    - Upload date
    - Verification status

Document Verification

1. Open document details
2. Review document:
    - Check document type
    - Verify document authenticity
    - Review document content
3. Update verification status:
    - **Verified**: Document is valid
    - **Rejected**: Document is invalid or incomplete
    - **Pending**: Requires further review
4. Add verification notes
5. Save changes

Document Templates

1. Navigate to **Documents** → **Document Templates**
2. View available templates:
    - Application Form Template
    - Recommendation Letter Template
    - Interview Checklist Template
    - Acceptance Letter Template
    - Rejection Letter Template
    - Waitlist Letter Template
    - Enrollment Form Template
    - Medical Form Template
3. Download templates
4. Customize templates (if permitted)

Uploading Documents (for Applications)

1. Open application details
2. Navigate to **Documents** section
3. Click **"Upload Document"**
4. Select document type
5. Choose file (PDF, DOC, DOCX, JPG, PNG, GIF, WEBP)
6. Maximum file size: 10MB
7. Click **"Upload"**

Reports & Analytics

Admissions Reports

1. Navigate to **Reports** tab or **Reports** → **Admissions Reports**
2. Available reports:
    - **Application Summary**: Overview of all applications
    - **Status Distribution**: Breakdown by status
    - **Grade Distribution**: Applications by grade level
    - **Enrollment Trends**: Historical enrollment data
    - **Processing Time**: Average time to process applications
    - **Approval Rates**: Approval statistics

Generating Reports

1. Select report type
2. Set date range
3. Apply filters (status, grade, etc.)
4. Click **"Generate Report"**
5. View report
6. Export as PDF, Excel, or CSV

Analytics Dashboard

1. Navigate to **Analytics** in sidebar
2. View:
    - Application trends
    - Grade-level statistics
    - Status distribution charts
    - Processing time metrics
    - Enrollment rate trends

Performance Metrics

1. Navigate to **Reports** → **Performance Metrics**
2. View:
    - Application processing time
    - Interview completion rate
    - Document verification time
    - Approval rate
    - Enrollment conversion rate

Enrollment Trends

1. Navigate to **Reports** → **Enrollment Trends**
2. View:
    - Historical enrollment data
    - Seasonal trends
    - Grade-level trends
    - Application source trends

Transcripts

1. Navigate to **Reports** → **Transcripts**
2. View and manage student transcripts
3. Generate transcript reports
4. Export transcripts

Communication Center

Communication Dashboard

1. Navigate to **Communication** tab or **Communication** → **Communication Center**
2. Features:
    - View all communications
    - Send new messages
    - Manage templates
    - Bulk messaging

Sending Individual Messages

1. Open application details
2. Click **"Send Message"** or **"Contact"**
3. Select message type:
    - Email
    - SMS (if configured)
    - In-app notification
4. Choose template or compose new message
5. Customize message content
6. Send message

Email Templates

1. Navigate to **Communication** → **Email Templates**
2. View existing templates:
    - Application Received
    - Interview Scheduled
    - Application Approved
    - Application Rejected
    - Documents Required
    - Enrollment Confirmation
3. **Create New Template**:
    - Click **"New Template"**
    - Enter template name
    - Write template content
    - Use variables: `{studentName}`, `{applicationNumber}`, etc.
    - Save template
4. **Edit Template**:
    - Click template name
    - Click **"Edit"**
    - Make changes
    - Save
5. **Delete Template**:
    - Click template name
    - Click **"Delete"**
    - Confirm deletion

Bulk Communications

1. Navigate to **Communication** → **Bulk Communications**
2. Select recipients:
    - All pending applications
    - Specific status
    - Specific grade
    - Custom selection
3. Choose template or compose message
4. Preview message
5. Send bulk message

Notifications

1. Navigate to **Notifications** in sidebar
2. View:
    - System notifications

    - Application updates
    - Interview reminders
    - Document verification requests
3. Mark as read/unread
4. Filter by type

Import & Export

Importing Applications

Step 1: Prepare CSV File

1. Navigate to **Import** in sidebar or click **"Import Data"** from dashboard
2. Download CSV template
3. Fill in application data:
    - **Required Fields**: Student Name, Grade, Contact Email, Contact Phone, Parent Name, Date of Birth
    - **Optional Fields**: Status, Application Date, Previous School, Notes, etc.
4. Save as CSV file

Step 2: Preview Data

1. Click **"Choose File"**
2. Select your CSV file
3. Click **"Preview Data"**
4. Review:
    - Data preview (first 5 records)
    - Validation warnings
    - Validation errors
5. Fix any errors in CSV file
6. Re-upload if needed

Step 3: Import

1. After preview shows no errors, click **"Import Applications"**
2. Wait for import to complete
3. Review import summary:
    - Total records
    - Successfully imported
    - Warnings
    - Errors
4. View imported applications in Applications list

CSV Format Requirements

- **Headers**: First row must contain column headers
- **Date Format**: YYYY-MM-DD (e.g., 2024-01-15)
- **File Size**: Maximum 10MB
- **Encoding**: UTF-8
- **Delimiter**: Comma (,)

Common Import Errors

- **Duplicate Email**: Email already exists in system
- **Invalid Date Format**: Date must be YYYY-MM-DD
- **Missing Required Field**: Required field is empty
- **Invalid Grade**: Grade not found in system

Exporting Data

1. Navigate to **Export** in sidebar or click **"Export Data"** from dashboard
2. Select export type:
    - **Applications**: All application data
    - **Reports**: Generated reports
    - **Calendar**: Interview calendar
3. Set filters:
    - Date range
    - Status
    - Grade
    - Other criteria
4. Choose export format:
    - Excel (.xlsx)
    - CSV (.csv)
    - PDF (for reports)
5. Click **"Export"**
6. Download file

Export Options

Applications Export Includes:

- Application number
- Student information
- Parent information
- Application status
- Dates
- Documents status

- Interview information

Custom Exports:

- Select specific fields
- Apply custom filters
- Choose date ranges
- Include/exclude specific data

Settings & Profile

Admissions Settings

1. Navigate to **Settings** tab or **Settings** → **Admissions Settings**
2. Configure:
    - **Application Settings**:
        - Default academic year
        - Application fee amount
        - Application deadline
        - Required documents by grade
    - **Workflow Settings**:
        - Approval workflow
        - Auto-notification settings
        - Status change notifications
    - **Document Settings**:
        - Required document types
        - Document size limits
        - Allowed file types
    - **Communication Settings**:
        - Email templates
        - Notification preferences
        - Auto-email settings

Profile Management

1. Navigate to **Profile** in sidebar
2. View and edit:
    - Personal information
    - Contact details
    - Profile picture
    - Password

    - Notification preferences
3. Save changes

Help & Support

1. Navigate to **Help** in sidebar
2. Access:
    - User manual (this document)
    - FAQ section
    - Video tutorials
    - Contact support
    - Feature requests

HRMS & Payroll Integration

Leave Management

1. Navigate to **HRMS → Leave Management**
2. View leave balance
3. Request leave:
    - Select leave type
    - Enter dates
    - Add reason
    - Submit request
4. View leave history
5. Approve/reject leave requests (if permitted)

Payroll Overview

1. Navigate to **Payroll → Payroll Overview**
2. View:
    - Current salary
    - Payroll history
    - Deductions
    - Benefits

Payslips

1. Navigate to **Payroll → Payslips**
2. View and download payslips
3. Filter by month/year
4. Export payslips

Payroll Reports

1. Navigate to **Payroll** → **Payroll Reports**
2. Generate reports:
    - Salary statements
    - Tax reports
    - Deduction reports
    - Benefits reports

Training & Development

1. Navigate to **Training** in sidebar
2. View available training programs
3. Enroll in training
4. Track training progress
5. View certificates

Help & Support

Accessing Help

1. Click **"Help & Support"** in sidebar
2. Or click **"?"** icon in top navigation

Available Resources

- **User Manual**: Complete documentation
- **FAQ**: Frequently asked questions
- **Video Tutorials**: Step-by-step video guides
- **Contact Support**: Submit support tickets
- **Feature Requests**: Suggest new features

Contacting Support

1. Navigate to **Help** → **Contact Support**
2. Fill in support form:
    - Issue type
    - Description
    - Screenshots (if applicable)
3. Submit ticket
4. Track ticket status

Troubleshooting

Common Issues

Cannot Access Dashboard

Problem: Getting redirected to login page

Solutions:

1. Check if you're logged in
2. Verify your role has admissions-officer permissions
3. Clear browser cache and cookies
4. Try logging in again
5. Contact system administrator

Applications Not Loading

Problem: Applications list is empty or not loading

Solutions:

1. Check internet connection
2. Refresh the page
3. Clear browser cache
4. Check if filters are too restrictive
5. Try logging out and back in
6. Contact support if issue persists

Document Upload Fails

Problem: Cannot upload documents

Solutions:

1. Check file size (max 10MB)
2. Verify file type is allowed (PDF, DOC, DOCX, JPG, PNG, GIF, WEBP)
3. Check internet connection
4. Try a different browser
5. Clear browser cache
6. Contact support if issue persists

Email Not Sending

Problem: Emails are not being sent

Solutions:

1. Check email template configuration
2. Verify recipient email addresses
3. Check spam/junk folder
4. Verify email service is configured
5. Contact system administrator

Import Errors

Problem: CSV import fails or shows errors

Solutions:

1. Verify CSV format matches template
2. Check for required fields
3. Verify date formats (YYYY-MM-DD)
4. Check for duplicate emails
5. Review error messages in import preview
6. Fix errors and re-import

Performance Issues

Slow Loading

Solutions:

1. Check internet connection speed
2. Clear browser cache
3. Close unnecessary browser tabs
4. Try a different browser
5. Contact support if issue persists

Timeout Errors

Solutions:

1. Check internet connection
2. Refresh the page
3. Try again after a few minutes

4. Contact support if issue persists

Best Practices

Application Management

1. **Review Regularly**: Check pending applications daily
2. **Update Status Promptly**: Keep application statuses current
3. **Document Everything**: Add notes for important decisions
4. **Verify Documents**: Thoroughly review all uploaded documents
5. **Communicate Clearly**: Send clear, professional communications

Interview Management

1. **Schedule Early**: Schedule interviews as soon as possible
2. **Send Reminders**: Send interview reminders 24-48 hours before
3. **Take Notes**: Document interview observations
4. **Follow Up**: Update application status after interviews

Document Management

1. **Verify Promptly**: Review documents within 24-48 hours
2. **Request Missing Documents**: Promptly request missing documents
3. **Organize Documents**: Keep documents organized by application
4. **Secure Storage**: Ensure documents are securely stored

Communication

1. **Use Templates**: Use email templates for consistency
2. **Personalize Messages**: Customize templates when appropriate
3. **Respond Promptly**: Respond to inquiries within 24 hours
4. **Be Professional**: Maintain professional tone in all communications

Reporting

1. **Regular Reports**: Generate reports regularly
2. **Track Metrics**: Monitor key performance indicators
3. **Analyze Trends**: Review trends to improve processes
4. **Share Insights**: Share reports with relevant stakeholders

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Keyboard Shortcuts

- **Ctrl/Cmd + K**: Open search
- **Ctrl/Cmd + N**: New application
- **Ctrl/Cmd + S**: Save
- **Ctrl/Cmd + E**: Export
- **Ctrl/Cmd + I**: Import
- **Esc**: Close dialogs/modals

Security & Privacy

Data Security

- All data is encrypted in transit and at rest
- Multi-tenant isolation ensures school data separation
- Role-based access control restricts unauthorized access
- Audit logs track all system activities

Privacy

- Student and parent information is confidential
- Only authorized personnel can access application data
- Documents are securely stored
- Communication is encrypted

Best Practices

1. **Logout**: Always logout when finished
2. **Password Security**: Use strong passwords
3. **Shared Computers**: Never save passwords on shared computers
4. **Report Issues**: Report security concerns immediately

Appendix

Application Status Codes

- `submitted`: Application submitted
- `pending`: Pending review

- `interview_scheduled`: Interview scheduled
- `documents_required`: Documents needed
- `documents_verified`: Documents verified
- `approved`: Application approved
- `rejected`: Application rejected
- `enrolled`: Student enrolled

Document Types

- Birth Certificate
- Previous School Records
- Medical Records
- Recommendation Letters
- Passport/ID
- Proof of Address
- Academic Transcripts
- Other Supporting Documents

File Size Limits

- **Documents**: 10MB maximum
- **CSV Import**: 10MB maximum
- **Images**: 10MB maximum

Supported File Formats

- **Documents**: PDF, DOC, DOCX
- **Images**: JPG, JPEG, PNG, GIF, WEBP
- **Data**: CSV, XLSX

Version History

- **Version 1.0** (Current): Initial release
    - Complete application management
    - Interview scheduling
    - Document management
    - Communication tools
    - Reporting and analytics
    - Import/Export functionality

Contact Information

For support, questions, or feature requests:

- **Email**: support@slatesms.com
  Documentation: This manual

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This manual is maintained by the SlateSMS development team. For the most up-to-date information, please refer to the in-app help section.